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|  <b>Department of<br/>Children &amp;<br/>Family Services</b><br><i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i> | <b>Division/Section</b>  | Family Support                                               |
|                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Chapter No./Name</b>  | 4-Economic Stability (ES)                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Part No./Name</b>     | O-DISASTER SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM (DSNAP) |
|                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Section No./Name</b>  | O-200-DSNAP IMPLEMENTATION                                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Document No./Name</b> | O-240-DSNAP Application to FNS to Implement DSNAP            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Effective Date</b>    | June 1, 2011                                                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                       |                          |                                                              |

Once the assessment is complete and a decision is made to request approval to implement a DSNAP, the application to implement the DSNAP is submitted by **\* DCFS \*\*** to FNS. This application process consists of an informal verbal application followed by a formal written application.

### **O-241-DSNAP INFORMAL APPLICATION**

The informal application is usually submitted by phone, fax, or e-mail to the Regional FNS and must take place no later than two weeks after the disaster occurs. During this process, FNS and **\* DCFS \*\*** will negotiate and agree on the terms of the DSNAP. The informal application should include as much of the supporting information needed for the formal application as possible.

### **O-242-DSNAP FORMAL APPLICATION**

The formal application must be submitted in writing to the Regional FNS within 2 weeks of the informal application. The formal application shall include the following information:

- Date and type of disaster
- Description of geographical areas in need of assistance
- Statement that commercial channels of food distribution are available (or an estimate of when they will be available) and a statement that either:
  - a presidential declaration of a major disaster has been granted for individual assistance or
  - commercial channels of food distribution were disrupted.
- Determination that low-income households have lost food or are unable to purchase food
- Substantiation that food needs of these households cannot be met by the regular SNAP
- Estimate of the number of households expected to apply for DSNAP benefits
- Expected length of the DSNAP application period, not to exceed seven days
- Expected length of the benefit period
- Description of any waivers requested
- Description of residency requirement
- Description of available security resources to protect benefit cards, to protect staff, and to help control crowds

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- Crowd control measures
- Fraud control measures, including:
  - plans to conduct checks for duplicate participation,
  - methods to help prevent fraudulent applications, and
  - ways to deal with suspected fraud.
- Description of process by which applications will be processed and benefits will be issued
- Plans for notifying the public of availability of DSNAP
- Indication of whether the state will supplement the allotments for previously certified regular SNAP households, bringing each to the maximum allotment for its household size
- Indication of whether the state will issue mass replacements for previously certified regular SNAP households that lost food in the disaster
- Procedures to coordinate the other state agencies to obtain additional workers, if needed
- Description of post-disaster review activities